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阅读 C

我不再谈“女科学家”这个身份

记叙文 · 人物与观点 · 全文 354 词 · 逐句精读

¹ I don't ever want to talk about being a woman scientist again.

我再也不想谈论身为女科学家这件事了。

scientist n. 科学家

² There was a time in my life when people asked constantly for stories about what it's like to work in a field dominated by men.

我人生中曾有一段时间，人们总是请我讲些故事，讲讲在男性主导的领域工作是什么感受。

constantly adv. 不断地；总是

field n. 领域

dominate v. 支配；主导

³ I was never very good at telling those stories because truthfully I never found them interesting.

我从来都不太会讲这些故事，因为说实话，我从来不觉得它们有意思。

be good at 擅长

truthfully adv. 说实话

⁴ What I do find interesting is the **origin** of the **universe**,
the shape of **space-time** and the **nature** of **black holes**.

我真正感兴趣的，是宇宙的起源、时空的形态和黑洞的本质。

origin n. 起源

universe n. 宇宙

space-time n. 时空

nature n. 本质

black hole 黑洞

⁵ At 19, when I began studying astrophysics, it did not bother me in the least to be the only woman in the classroom.

19岁开始学天体物理时，我是教室里唯一的女生，但我对此一点也不在意。

astrophysics n. 天体物理学

bother v. 使烦恼

in the least 一点也不（不）

⁶ But while I was **earning** my Ph.D. at MIT and then working as a **postdoc** doing space **research**, the **issue** started to bother me.

但在麻省理工学院读博士期间，以及后来做太空研究的博士后时，这个问题开始困扰我。

earn v. 获得；赢得

postdoc n. 博士后（研究人员）

research n. 研究

issue n. 问题

⁷ My every **achievement**—jobs, research papers, **awards**—was viewed through the **lens** of **gender** (性别) **politics**.

我的每一项成就——工作、研究论文、奖项——都被放在性别政治的视角下审视。

achievement n. 成就

award n. 奖项

lens n. 镜头；视角

gender n. 性别

politics n. 政治

⁸ So were my **failures**.

我的失败也是如此。

failure n. 失败

- 9 Sometimes, when I was pushed into an **argument** on left brain **versus** (相对于) right brain, or nature versus **nurture** (培育), I would **instantly** fight **fiercely** **on my own behalf** and **on behalf of** all **womankind**.

有时，当我被卷入关于左脑与右脑、先天与后天的争论时，我会立刻为自己、也为全体女性激烈地争辩。

argument n. 争论

versus prep. 与……相对

nurture n. 培育；后天养育

instantly adv. 立即

fiercely adv. 激烈地

on one's own behalf 为了自己（的利益）

on behalf of 代表；为了……（的利益）

womankind n. 女性（总称）

¹⁰ Then one day a few years ago, out of my mouth came a sentence that would **eventually** become my **reply** to any and all **provocations**: I don't talk about that anymore.

后来，几年前的一天，我脱口说出了一句话，这句话最终成了我对一切挑衅的回答：我不再谈论那个话题了。

eventually adv. 最终

reply n. 回答

provocation n. 挑衅

¹¹ It took me 10 years to get back the **confidence** I had at 19 and to **realize** that I didn't want to **deal with** gender issues.

我花了10年时间，才找回19岁时的那份自信，并意识到自己不想去应付性别问题。

confidence n. 自信

realize v. 意识到

deal with 处理；应付

¹² Why should **curing** **sexism** be yet another terrible **burden** on every **female** scientist?

为什么消除性别歧视要成为每一位女科学家的又一个沉重负担？

cure v. 治愈；消除

sexism n. 性别歧视

burden n. 负担

female adj. 女性的

13 After all, I don't study sociology or political theory.

毕竟，我研究的又不是社会学或政治理论。

after all 毕竟

sociology n. 社会学

political adj. 政治的

theory n. 理论

¹⁴ Today I research and teach at Barnard, a women's college in New York City.

如今，我在巴纳德学院——纽约市的一所女子学院——做研究并授课。

research v. 研究

college n. 学院

¹⁵ Recently, someone asked me how many of the 45 students in my class were women.

最近，有人问我班上45名学生中有多少是女生。

recently adv. 最近

¹⁶ You cannot imagine my satisfaction at being able to answer, 45.

你想象不到，我能回答“45名”时有多满足。

imagine v. 想象

satisfaction n. 满足

¹⁷ I know some of my students **worry about** how they will **manage** their **scientific** research and a **desire** for children.

我知道，我的一些学生担心将来如何兼顾科研和想要孩子的愿望。

worry about 担心

manage v. 设法应付；兼顾

scientific adj. 科学的

desire n. 愿望

¹⁸ And I don't **dismiss** those **concerns**.

我并不轻视这些顾虑。

dismiss v. 不予考虑；轻视

concern n. 担忧

19 **Still**, I don't tell them “war” stories.

不过，我不会给她们讲那些“战斗”故事。

still adv. 不过；然而

²⁰ Instead, I have given them this: the visual of their physics professor, heavily pregnant, doing physics experiments.

相反，我给了她们这样一个画面：她们的物理教授挺着大肚子做物理实验。

instead adv. 相反

visual n. 画面；视觉形象

physics n. 物理学

pregnant adj. 怀孕的

experiment n. 实验

²¹ And **in turn** they have given me the **image** of 45 women **driven** by a love of science.

反过来，她们也给了我这样一幅图景：45名女性因热爱科学而奋进。

in turn 反过来

image n. 形象；图景

drive v. 驱动；激励

²² And that's a **sight** **worth talking** about.

这才是值得一谈的景象。

sight n. 景象

worth doing 值得做